

MERU UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE TECHNOLOGY



**DEPARTMENT OF ELECTRICAL AND ELECTRONICS
ENGINEERING**

**BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY IN ELECTRICAL AND
ELECTRONICS ENGINEERING**

LAB REPORT: LEAD AND LAG COMPENSATORS.

<https://github.com/joshuawambua/controlsystems.git>

UNIT CODE: EET 3407

UNIT DESCRIPTION: CONTROL SYSTEMS II.

NAME: JOSHUA MUTHENYA WAMBUA

REG NO: EG209/109705/22

Instructor: Dr. Agnes

Date: 14/12/2025

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Introduction

Control systems are fundamental in modern engineering applications where precise regulation of physical variables such as speed, position, temperature, and voltage is required. In practical systems, uncompensated plants often fail to meet desired transient and steady-state performance specifications. Compensation techniques are therefore introduced to modify system dynamics in order to achieve acceptable performance. This laboratory experiment focuses on the design, analysis, and simulation of lead, lag, and lead–lag compensators using MATLAB. Emphasis is placed on understanding how compensators affect system stability, transient response, and steady-state accuracy. Operational amplifiers are considered as the practical analog realization of these compensators, linking theoretical control concepts with real-world implementation.

Objectives

- i. To understand the principles of dynamic compensation in control systems.
- ii. To design lead, lag, and lead–lag compensators for first-order and second-order systems.
- iii. To analyze the effect of cascade compensation on transient and steady-state performance.
- iv. To simulate compensated and uncompensated systems using MATLAB.
- v. To evaluate system performance using time-domain and frequency-domain analysis tools such as step response, Bode plots, root locus, and Nyquist plots.

Results

MATLAB simulations were carried out for both first-order and second-order systems listed in Table 1 and Table 2. For each system, uncompensated and compensated responses were analyzed using:

1. Step response
2. Bode plots
3. Root locus
4. Nyquist plots

The results show that the introduction of a lead compensator significantly reduces rise time and settling time, while the lag compensator improves steady-state accuracy. The combined lead–lag compensator provides an optimal balance between transient performance and steady-state error reduction.

Quantitative performance indices such as rise time, settling time, peak value, and overshoot were obtained using the [stepinfo](#) function in MATLAB. In all cases, the compensated systems demonstrated superior performance compared to the uncompensated systems.

NOTE: For The First Order System, I Gave All The Scripts And The Plots But For The Second Order System I Just Gave A Single System, The Scripts For The Other Systems Are Available On The GitHub Link Provided on the cover page.

Table 1

1	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+3)}$	5	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+7)}$
2	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+4)}$	6	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+8)}$
3	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+5)}$	7	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+9)}$
4	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+6)}$	8	$G(s) = \frac{s}{s(s+10)}$

Table 1: first order systems

```
% =====
% NAME: Joshua Muthenya Wambua
% REG NO: EG209/109705/22
% DATE: 09-Nov-2025
% Objective:
%   To design and analyze a lead-lag compensated control system
%   for improved transient and steady-state performance.
```

```

% =====

clc; clear; close all;

%% -----
% Common definitions
% -----
s = tf('s'); % Laplace variable

% Lead compensator
C_lead = 10 * (s + 3) / (s + 11);

% Lag compensator
C_lag = (s + 2) / (s + 0.2);

% Combined lead-lag compensator
C_T = C_lead * C_lag;

%% =====
% SYSTEM 1 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+3)]$ 
% =====

G1 = s/(s*(s+3));

T_uncomp = feedback(G1,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G1,1);

figure('Name','Bode Plot Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
bode(G1, C_T*G1); grid on;
title('System 1: Bode Plot');
legend('Uncompensated','Compensated');

figure('Name','Step Response Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on;
title('System 1: Step Response');
legend('Uncompensated','Compensated');

figure('Name','Root Locus Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
rlocus(G1); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G1); grid on;

```

```

title('System 1: Root Locus');

figure('Name','Nyquist Plot Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
nyquist(G1, C_T*G1); grid on;
title('System 1: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 1 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

%% =====
% SYSTEM 2 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+4)]$ 
%% =====

G2 = s/(s*(s+4));

T_uncomp = feedback(G2,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G2,1);

figure; bode(G2, C_T*G2); grid on; title('System 2: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 2: Step Response');
figure; rlocus(G2); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G2); grid on; title('System 2: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G2, C_T*G2); grid on; title('System 2: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 2 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

%% =====
% SYSTEM 3 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+5)]$ 
%% =====

G3 = s/(s*(s+5));

T_uncomp = feedback(G3,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G3,1);

figure; bode(G3, C_T*G3); grid on; title('System 3: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 3: Step Response');

```

```

figure; rlocus(G3); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G3); grid on; title('System 3: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G3, C_T*G3); grid on; title('System 3: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 3 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

%% =====
% SYSTEM 4 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+6)]$ 
%% =====

G4 = s/(s*(s+6));

T_uncomp = feedback(G4,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G4,1);

figure; bode(G4, C_T*G4); grid on; title('System 4: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 4: Step Response');
figure; rlocus(G4); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G4); grid on; title('System 4: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G4, C_T*G4); grid on; title('System 4: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 4 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

%% =====
% SYSTEM 5 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+7)]$ 
%% =====

G5 = s/(s*(s+7));

T_uncomp = feedback(G5,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G5,1);

figure; bode(G5, C_T*G5); grid on; title('System 5: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 5: Step Response');
figure; rlocus(G5); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G5); grid on; title('System 5: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G5, C_T*G5); grid on; title('System 5: Nyquist Plot');

```

```

disp('SYSTEM 5 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

%% =====
% SYSTEM 6 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+8)]$ 
%% =====

G6 = s/(s*(s+8));

T_uncomp = feedback(G6,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G6,1);

figure; bode(G6, C_T*G6); grid on; title('System 6: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 6: Step Response');
figure; rlocus(G6); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G6); grid on; title('System 6: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G6, C_T*G6); grid on; title('System 6: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 6 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

%% =====
% SYSTEM 7 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+9)]$ 
%% =====

G7 = s/(s*(s+9));

T_uncomp = feedback(G7,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G7,1);

figure; bode(G7, C_T*G7); grid on; title('System 7: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 7: Step Response');
figure; rlocus(G7); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G7); grid on; title('System 7: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G7, C_T*G7); grid on; title('System 7: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 7 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

```



```

%% =====
% SYSTEM 8 :  $G(s) = s / [s(s+10)]$ 
%% =====

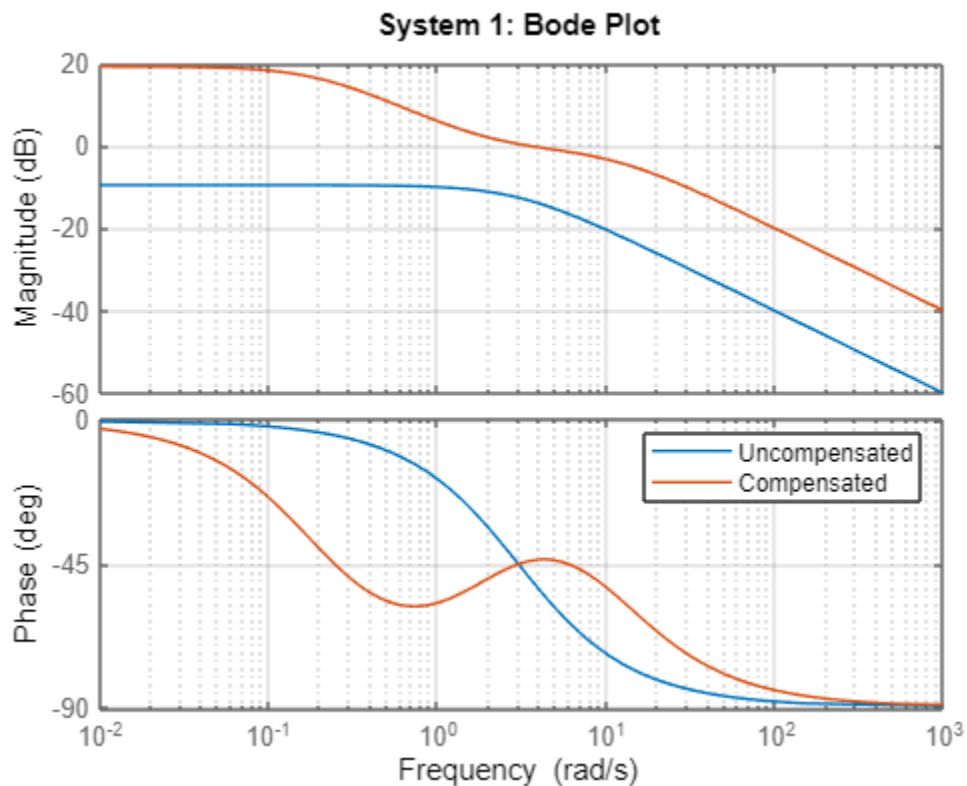
G8 = s/(s*(s+10));

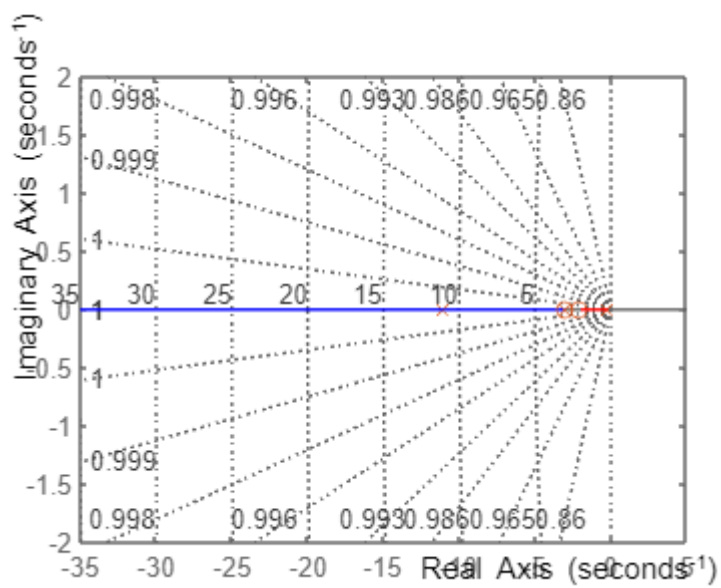
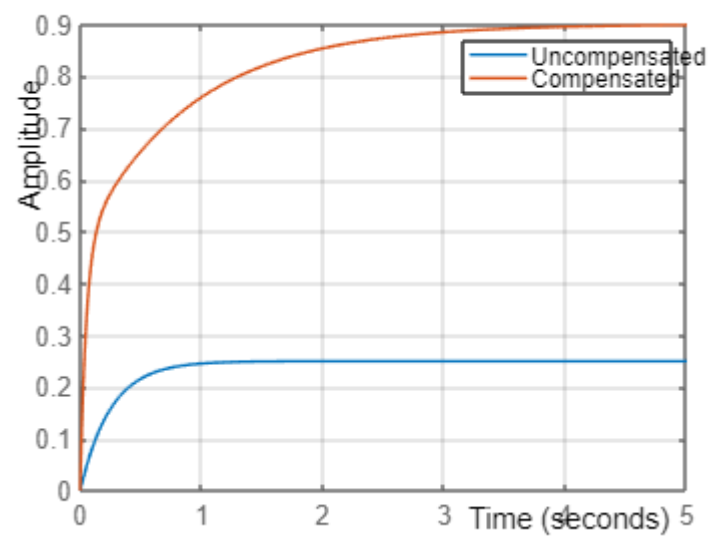
T_uncomp = feedback(G8,1);
T_comp = feedback(C_T*G8,1);

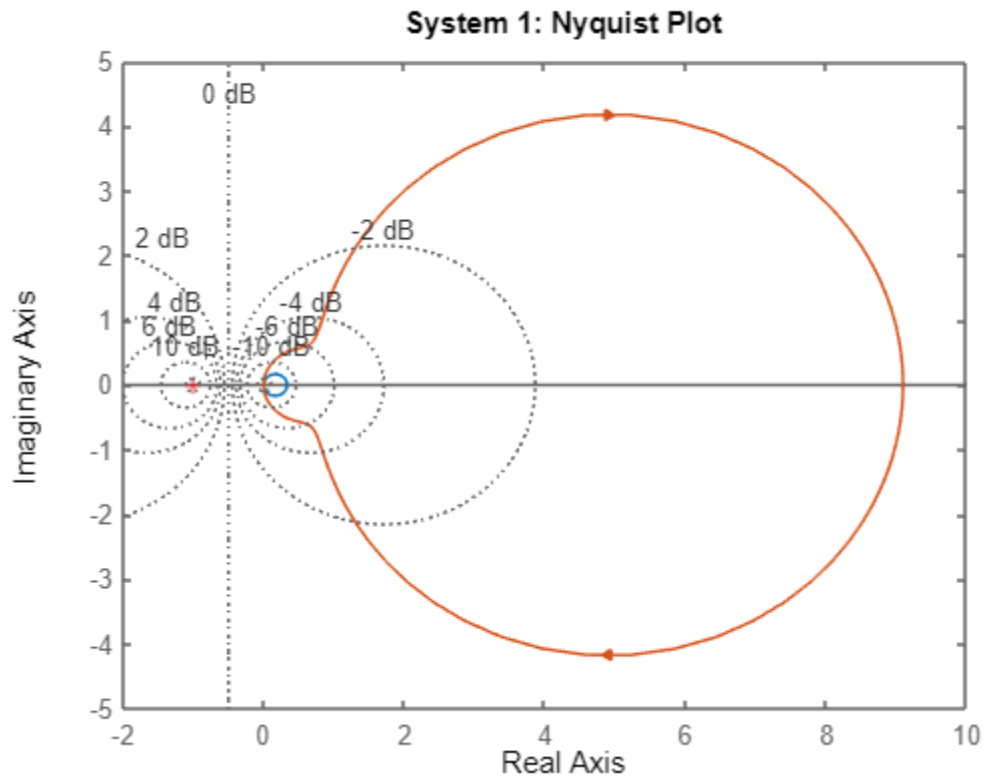
figure; bode(G8, C_T*G8); grid on; title('System 8: Bode Plot');
figure; step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 5); grid on; title('System 8: Step Response');
figure; rlocus(G8); hold on; rlocus(C_T*G8); grid on; title('System 8: Root Locus');
figure; nyquist(G8, C_T*G8); grid on; title('System 8: Nyquist Plot');

disp('SYSTEM 8 PERFORMANCE');
disp(stepinfo(T_uncomp));
disp(stepinfo(T_comp));

```

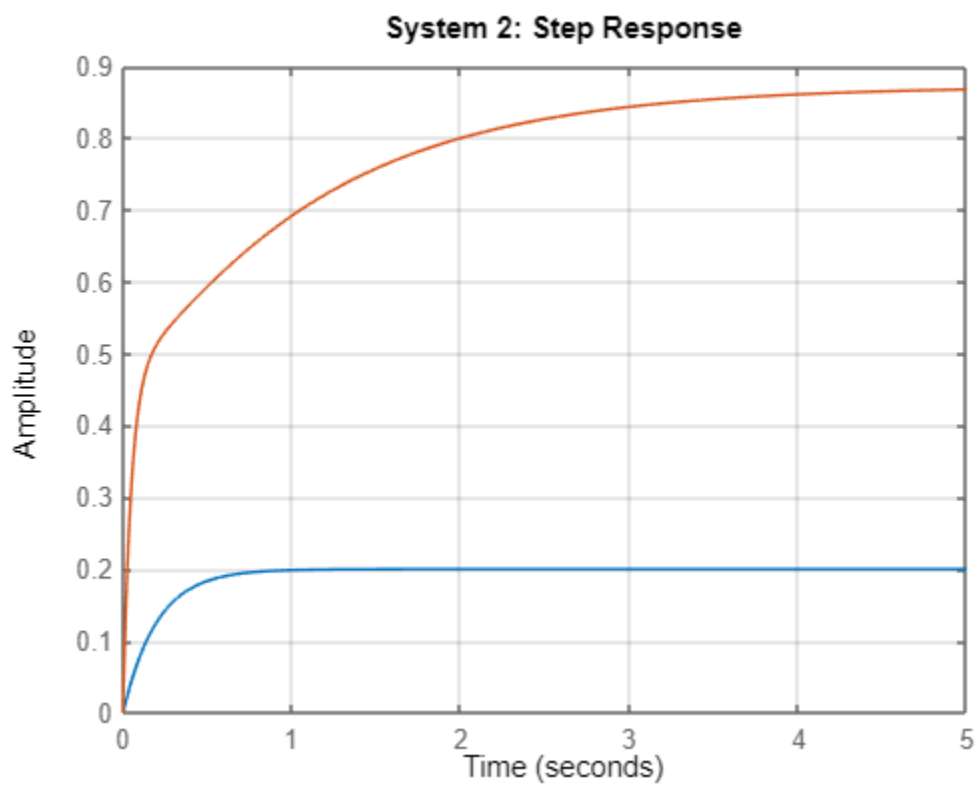
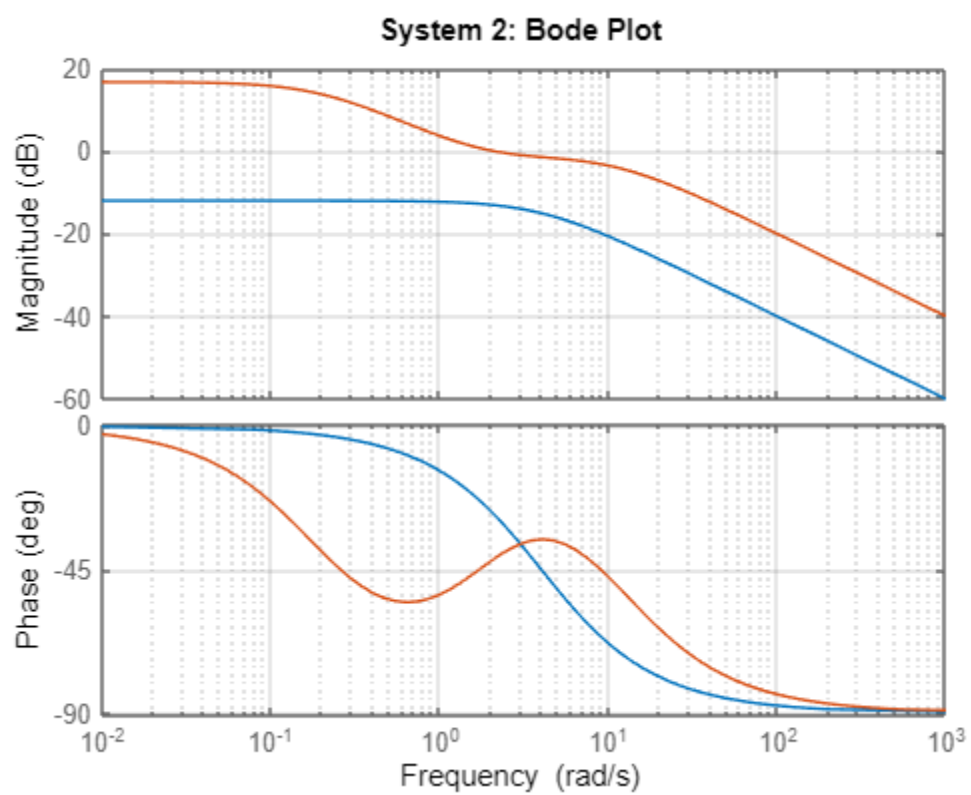


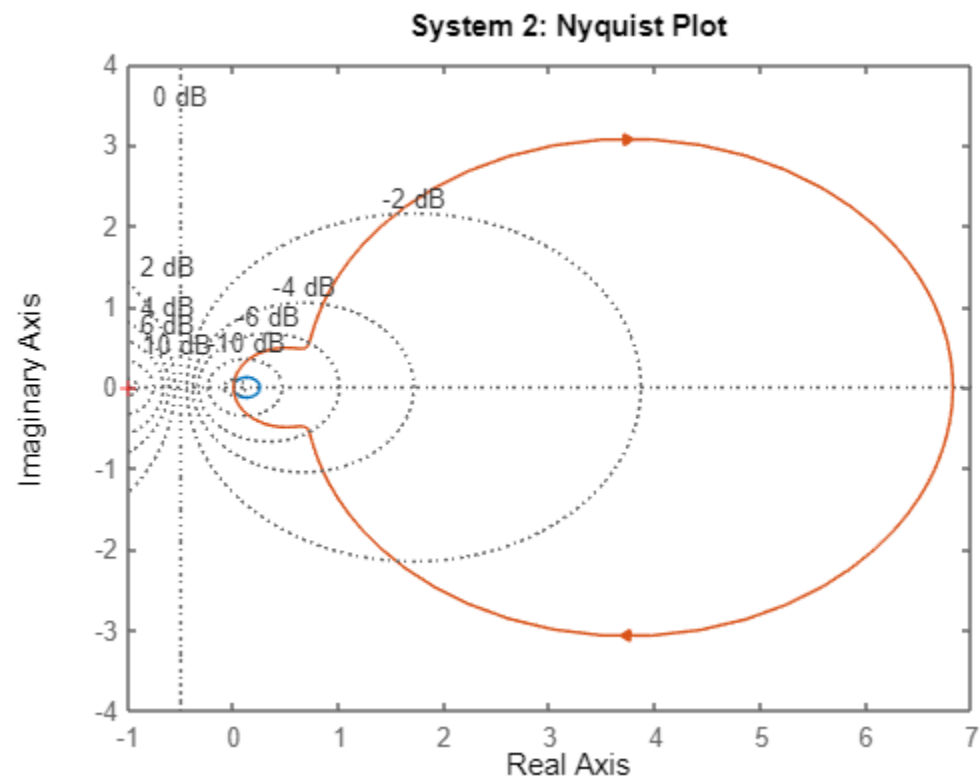
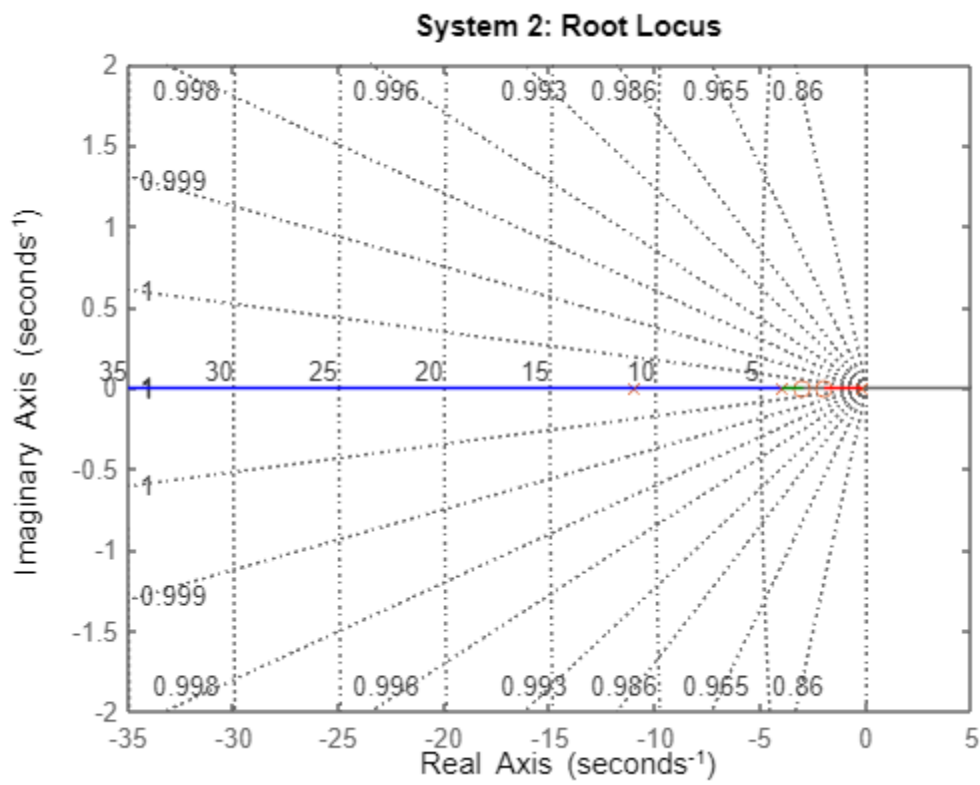




SYSTEM 1 PERFORMANCE

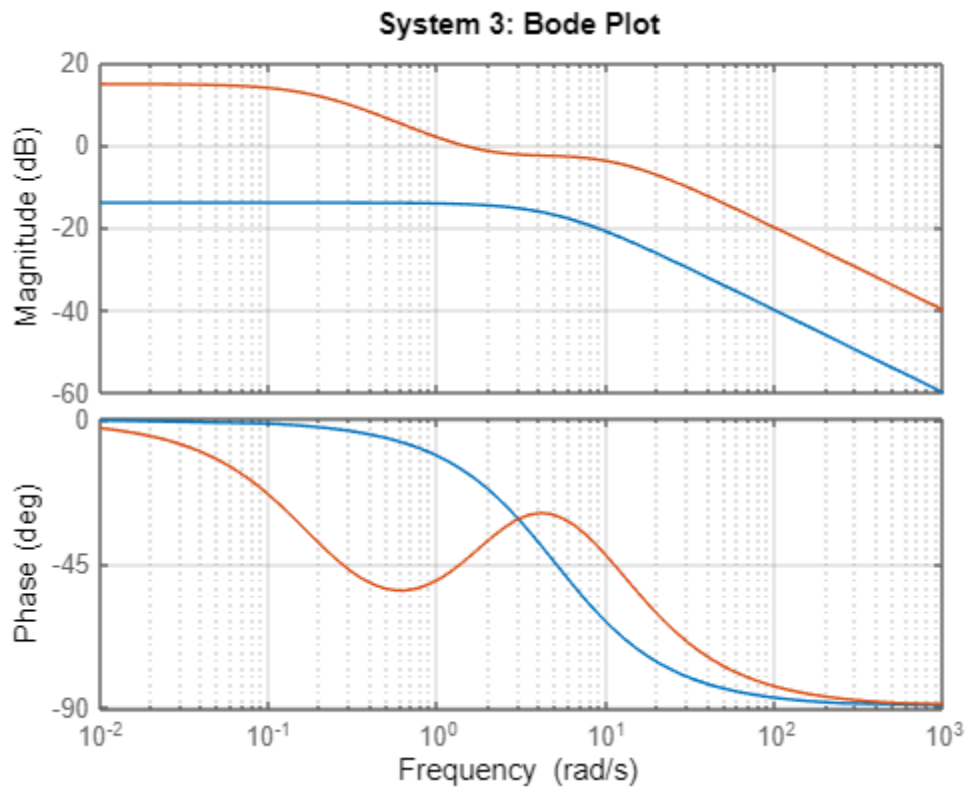
RiseTime: 0.5493
 TransientTime: 0.9780
 SettlingTime: 0.9780
 SettlingMin: 0.2261
 SettlingMax: 0.2500
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.2500
 PeakTime: 2.6365
 RiseTime: 1.3980
 TransientTime: 2.8647
 SettlingTime: 2.8647
 SettlingMin: 0.8112
 SettlingMax: 0.9002
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.9002
 PeakTime: 5.8621

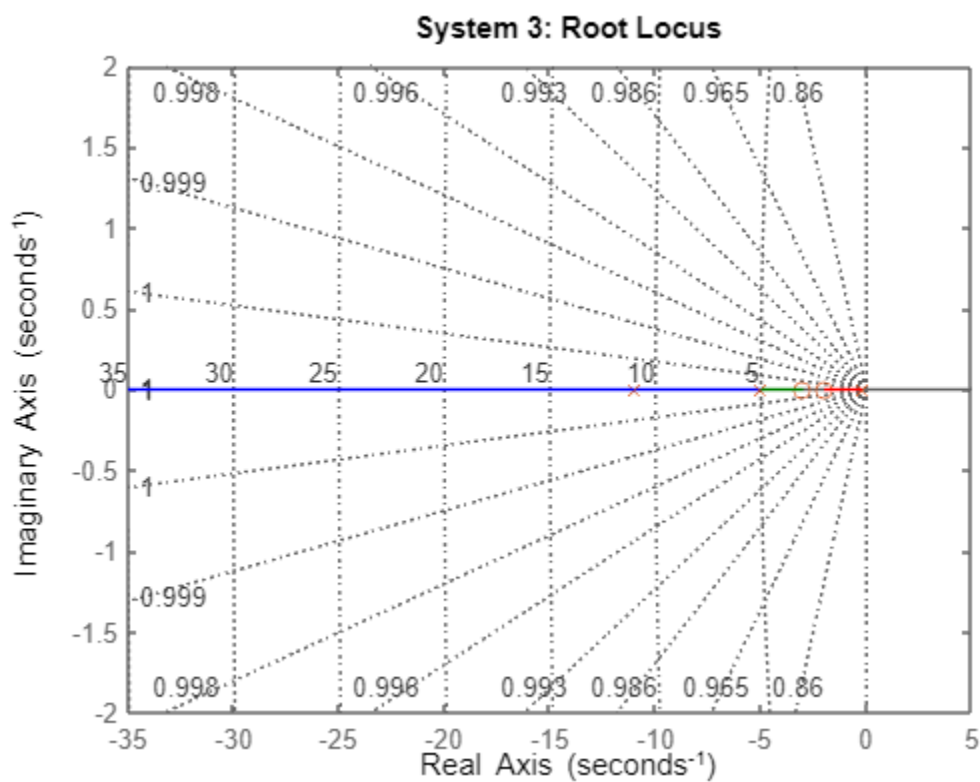
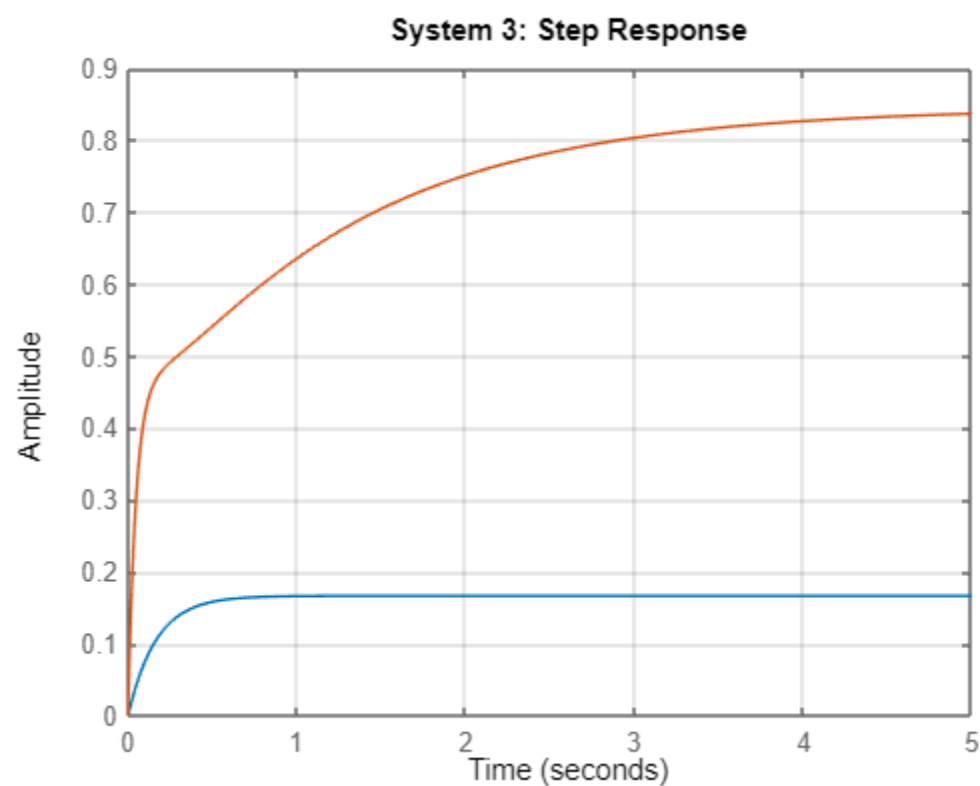


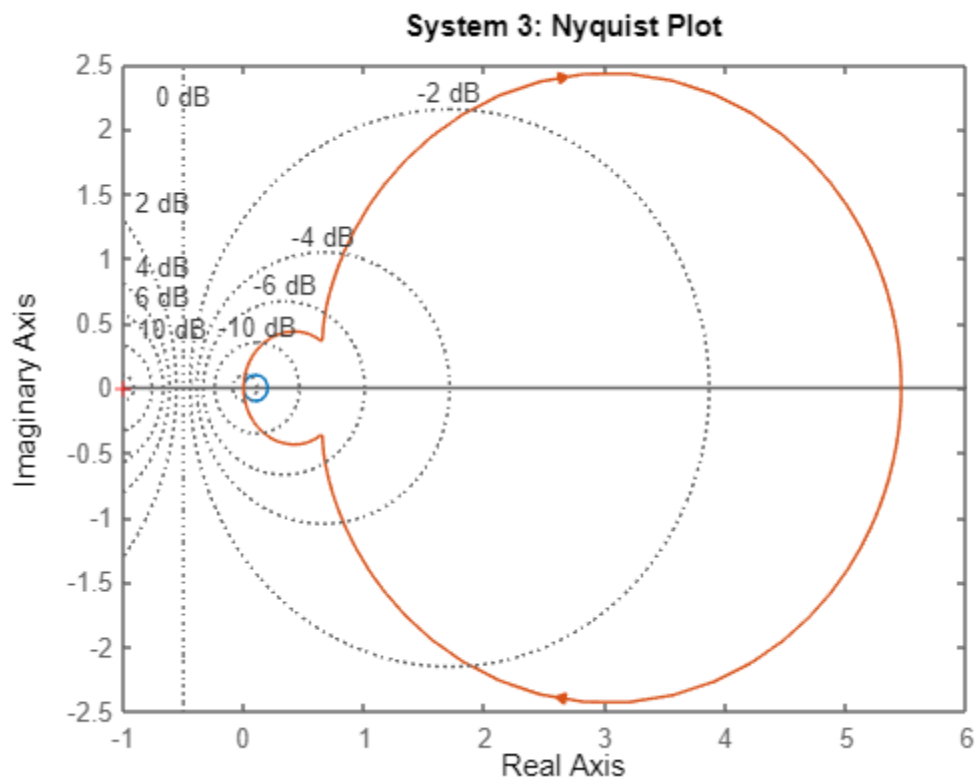


SYSTEM 2 PERFORMANCE

RiseTime: 0.4394
 TransientTime: 0.7824
 SettlingTime: 0.7824
 SettlingMin: 0.1809
 SettlingMax: 0.2000
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.2000
 PeakTime: 2.1092
 RiseTime: 1.7871
 TransientTime: 3.5433
 SettlingTime: 3.5433
 SettlingMin: 0.7852
 SettlingMax: 0.8700
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.8700
 PeakTime: 5.8334

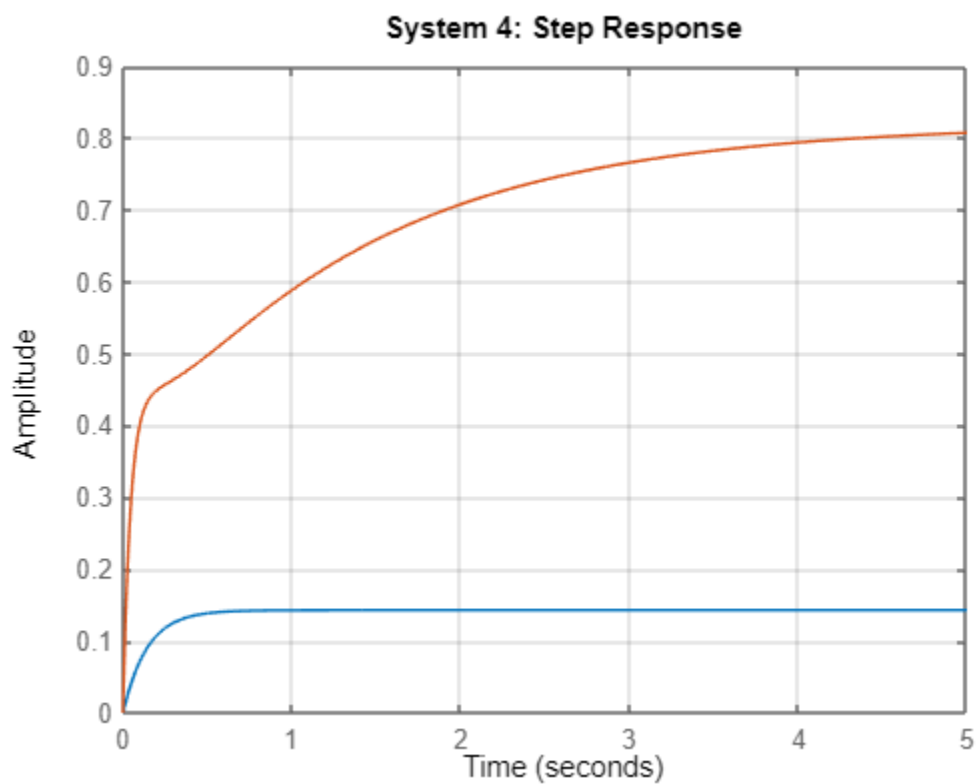
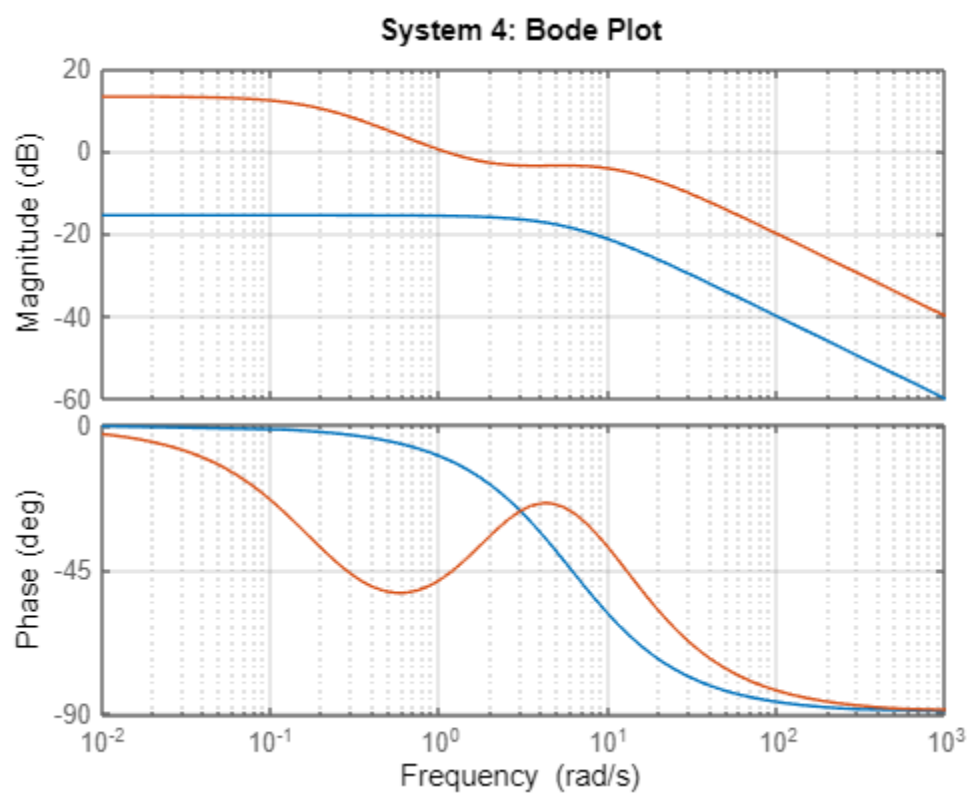


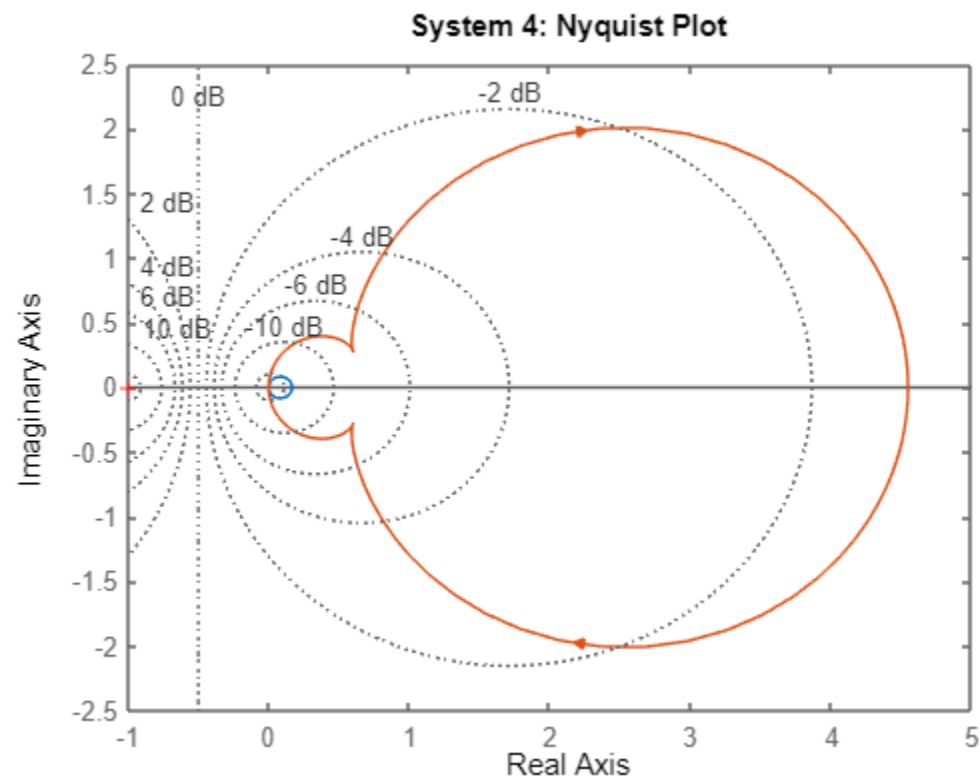
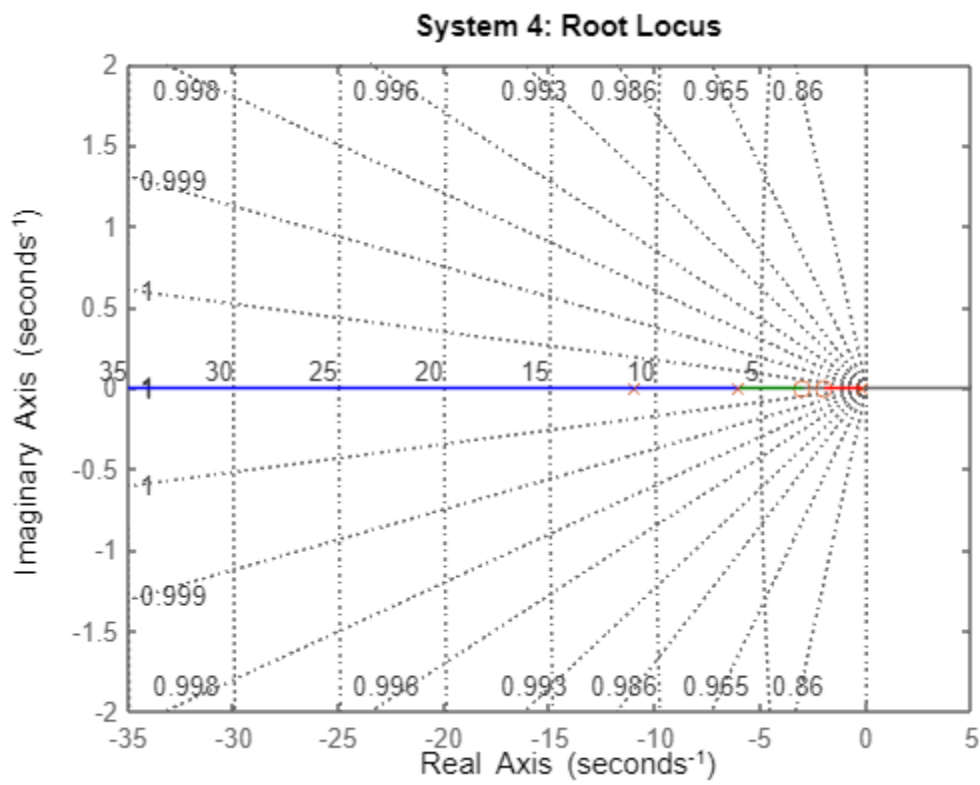




SYSTEM 3 PERFORMANCE

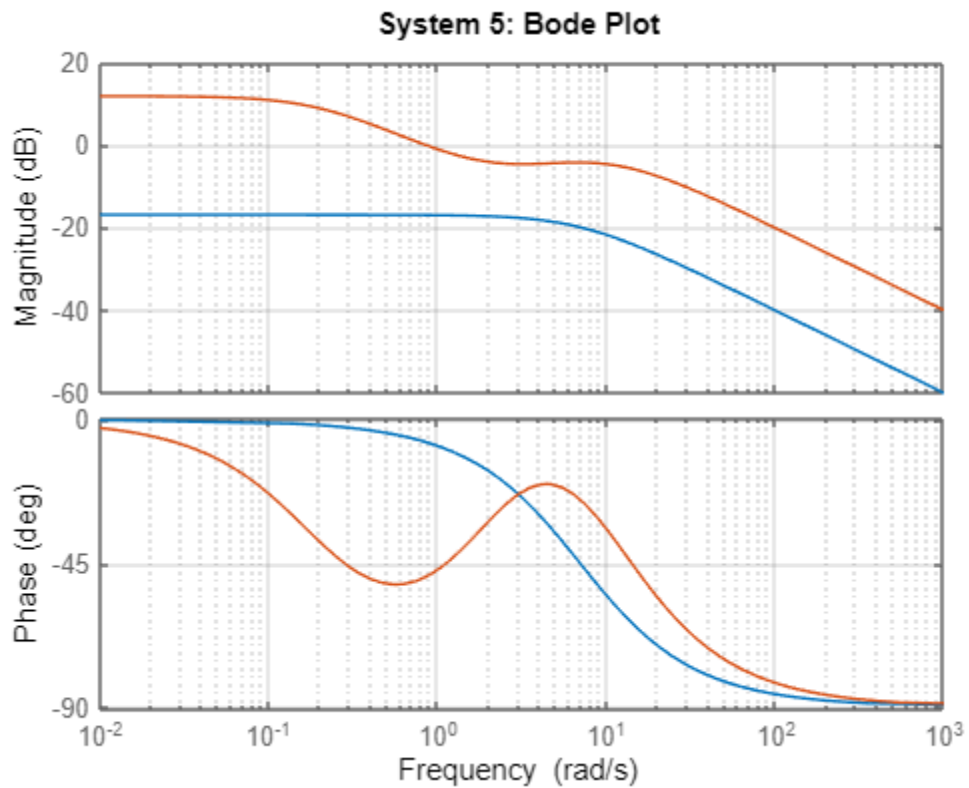
RiseTime: 0.3662
 TransientTime: 0.6520
 SettlingTime: 0.6520
 SettlingMin: 0.1508
 SettlingMax: 0.1667
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.1667
 PeakTime: 1.7576
 RiseTime: 2.1209
 TransientTime: 4.1168
 SettlingTime: 4.1168
 SettlingMin: 0.7606
 SettlingMax: 0.8448
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.8448
 PeakTime: 9.0891

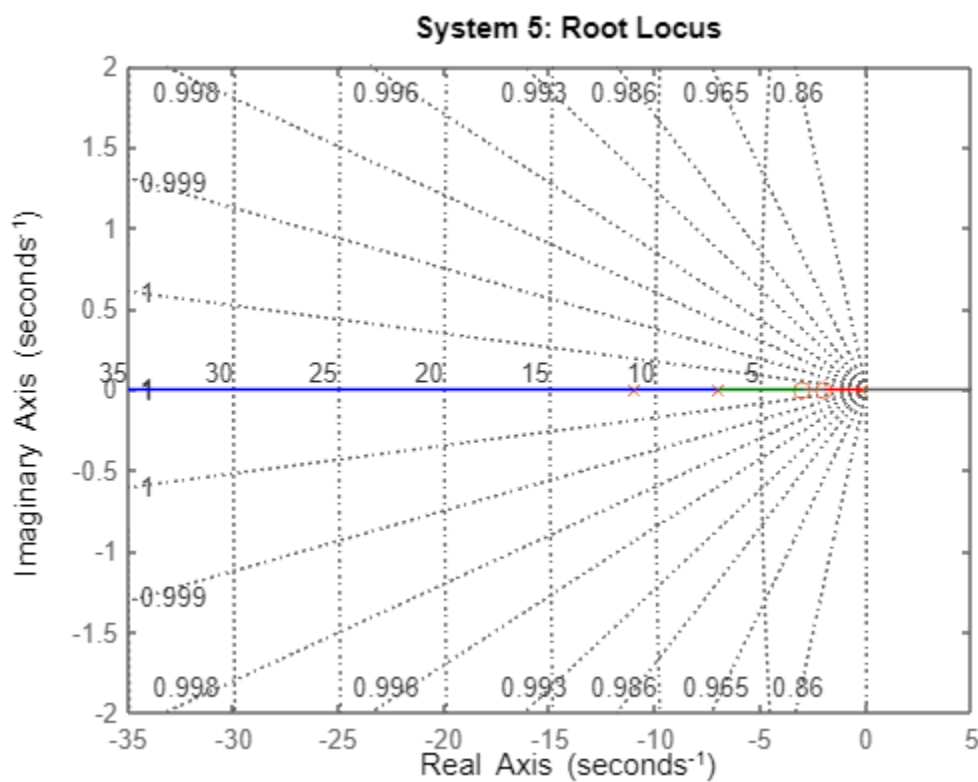
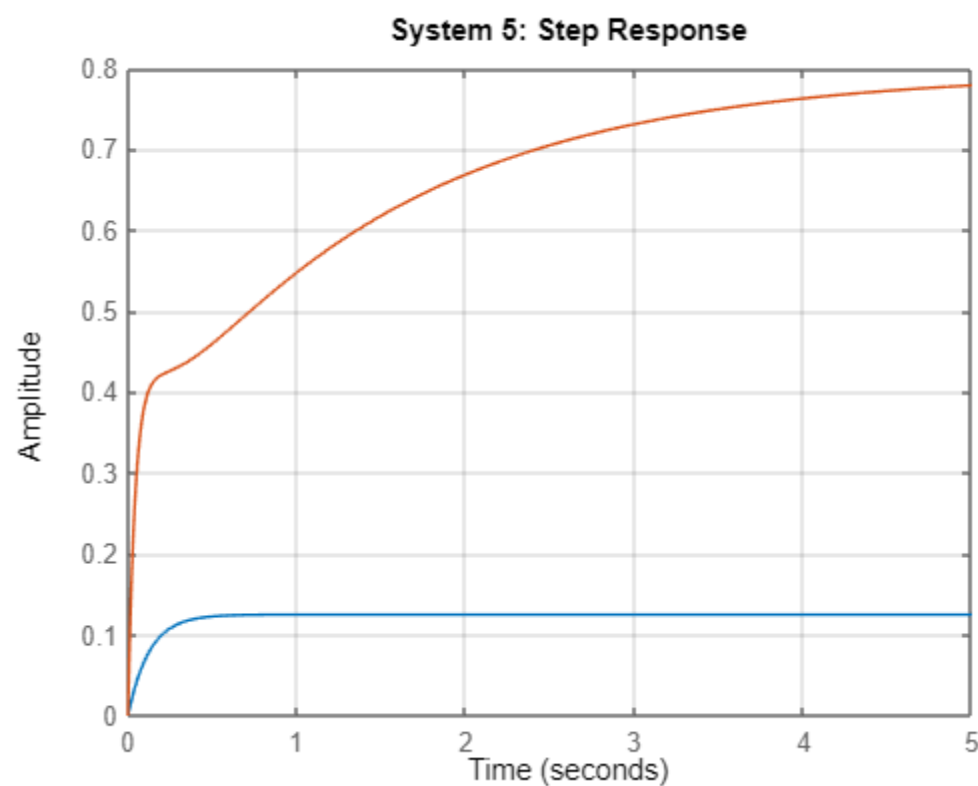


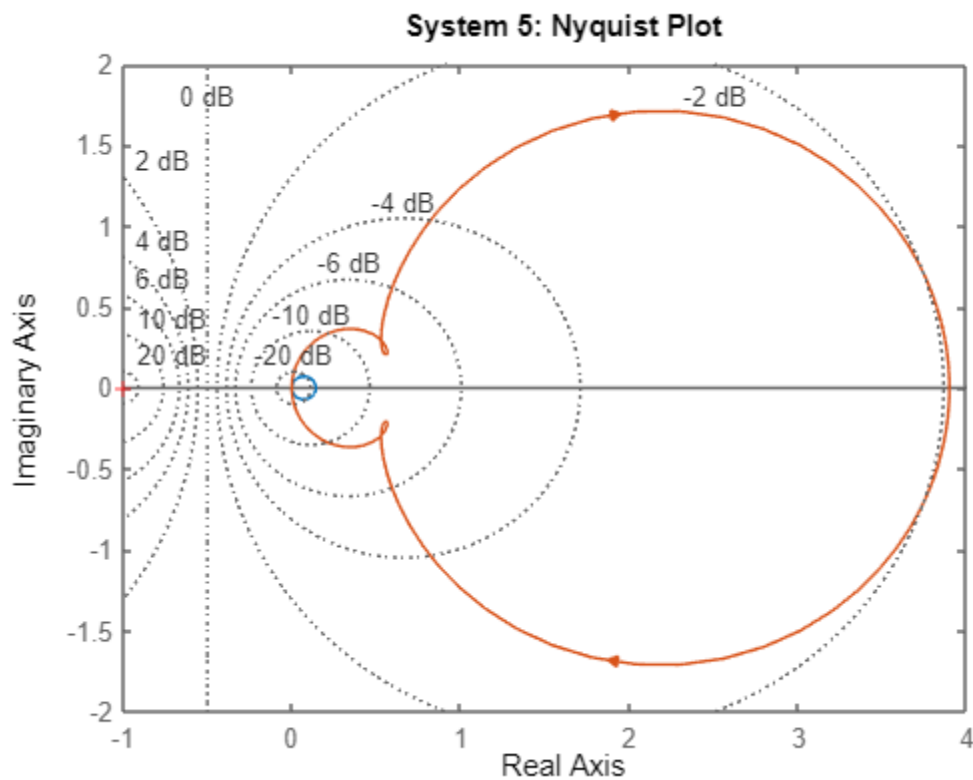


SYSTEM 4 PERFORMANCE

RiseTime: 0.3139
TransientTime: 0.5589
SettlingTime: 0.5589
SettlingMin: 0.1292
SettlingMax: 0.1429
Overshoot: 0
Undershoot: 0
Peak: 0.1429
PeakTime: 1.5065
RiseTime: 2.4179
TransientTime: 4.6264
SettlingTime: 4.6264
SettlingMin: 0.7379
SettlingMax: 0.8183
Overshoot: 0
Undershoot: 0
Peak: 0.8183
PeakTime: 8.0283

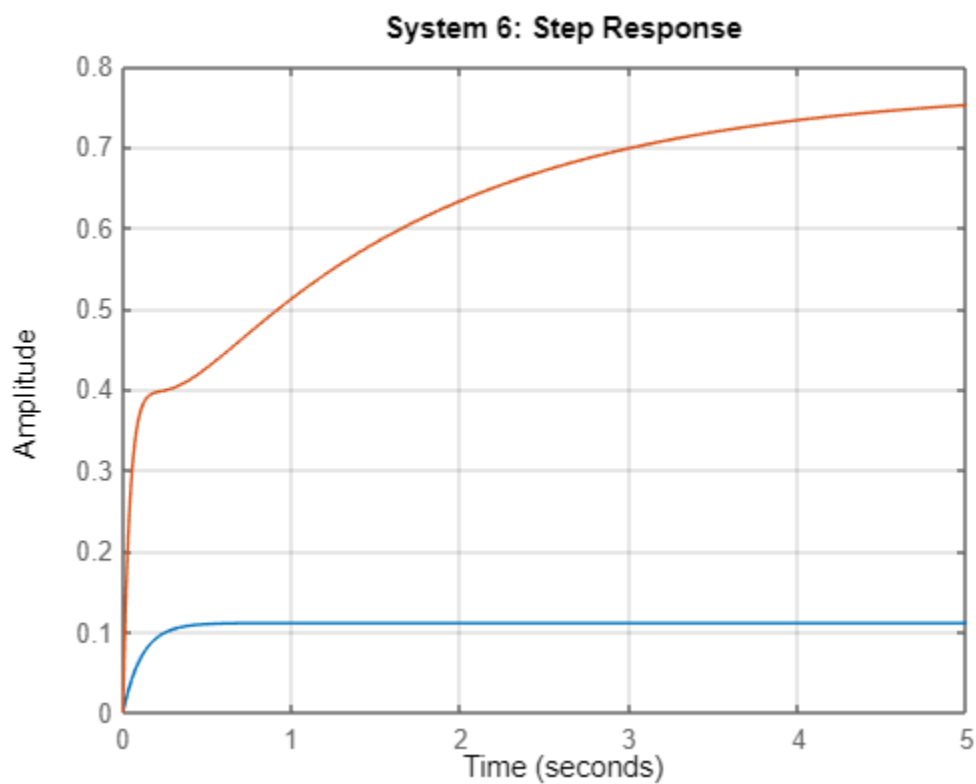
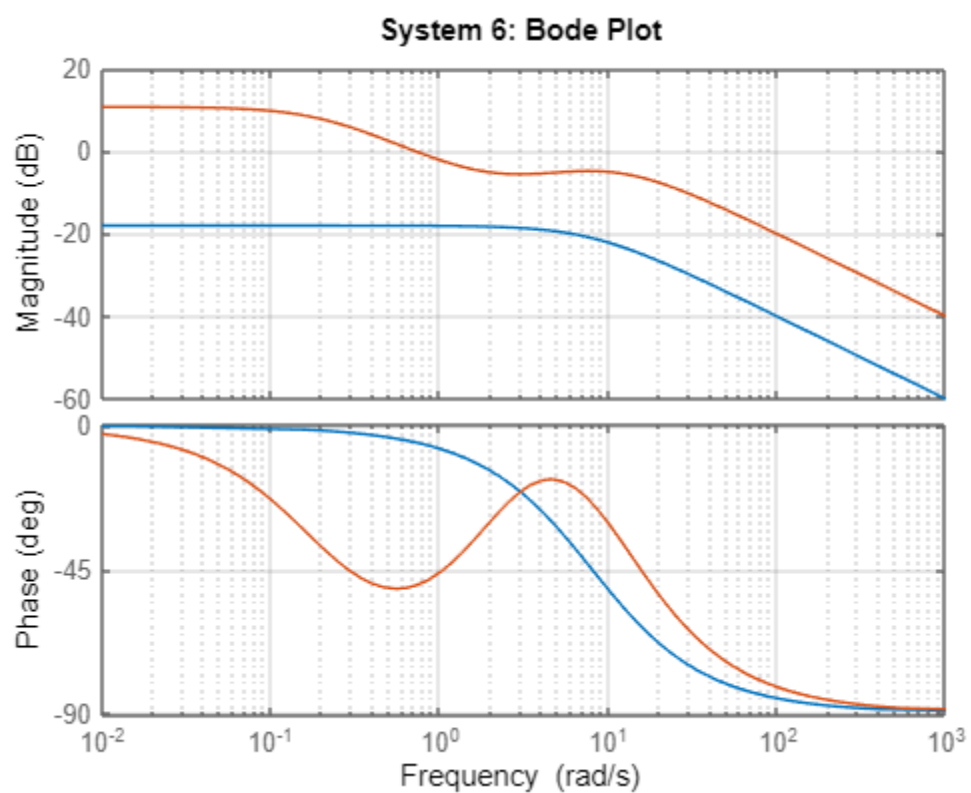


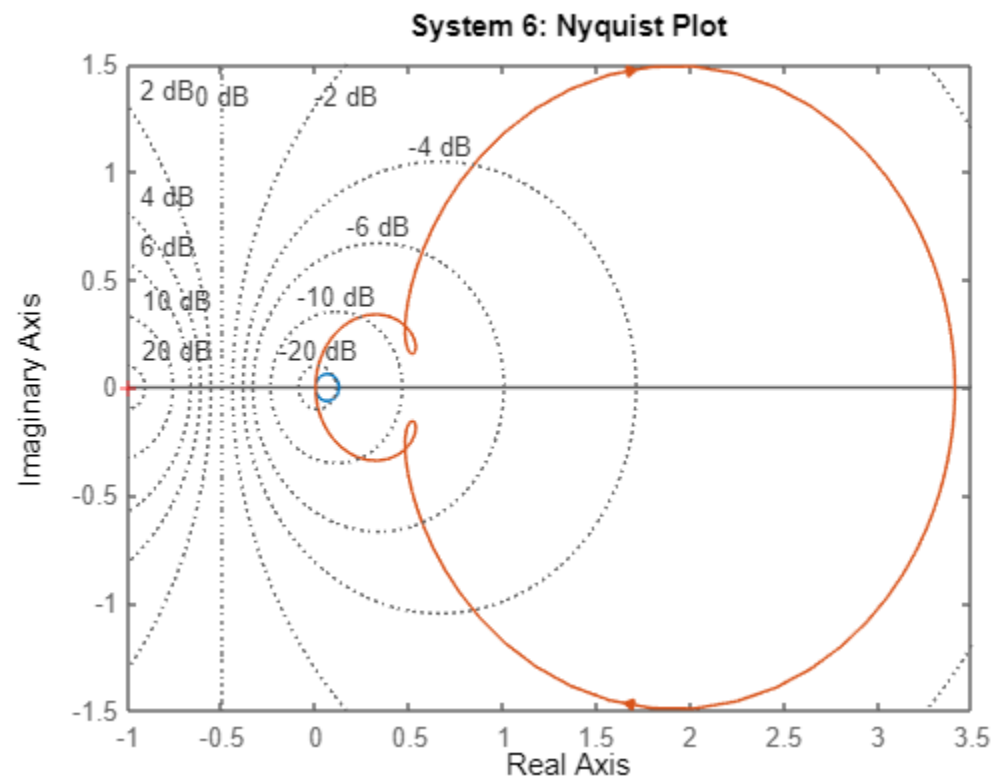
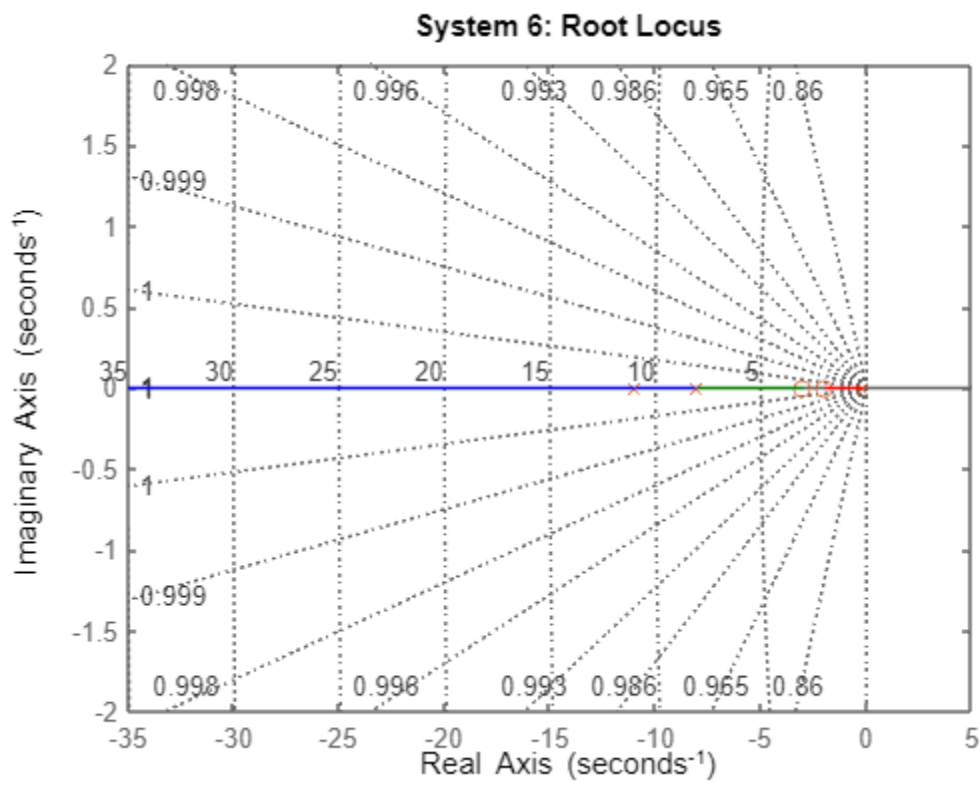




SYSTEM 5 PERFORMANCE

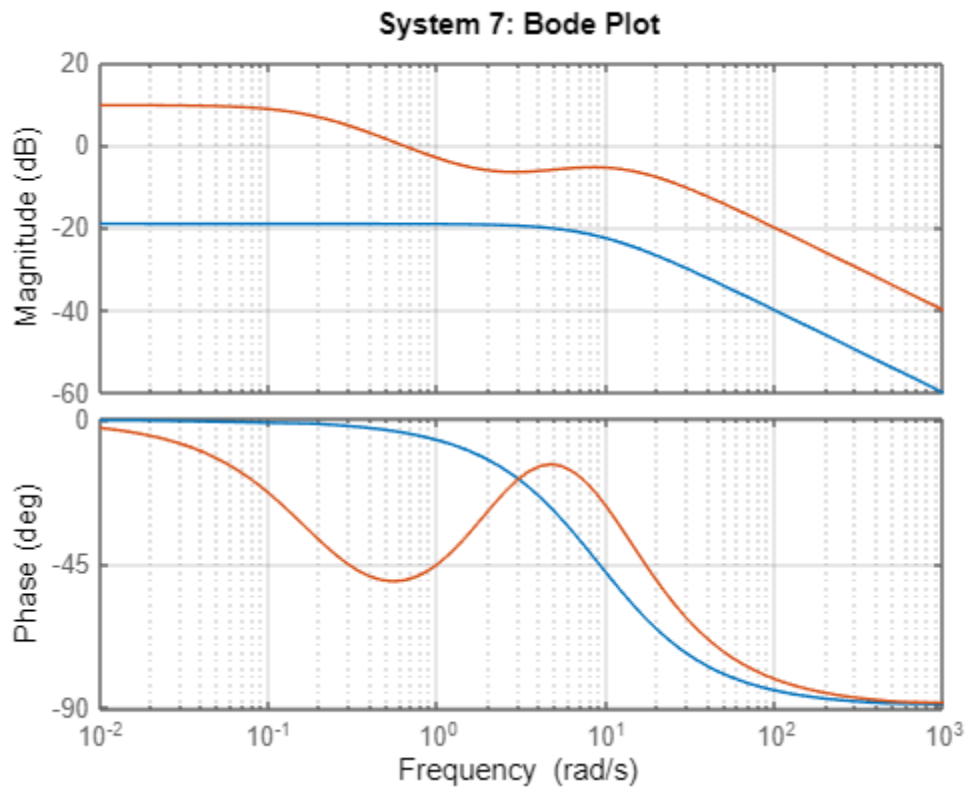
RiseTime: 0.2746
 TransientTime: 0.4890
 SettlingTime: 0.4890
 SettlingMin: 0.1131
 SettlingMax: 0.1250
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.1250
 PeakTime: 1.3182
 RiseTime: 2.6883
 TransientTime: 5.0895
 SettlingTime: 5.0895
 SettlingMin: 0.7163
 SettlingMax: 0.7940
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.7940
 PeakTime: 8.3248

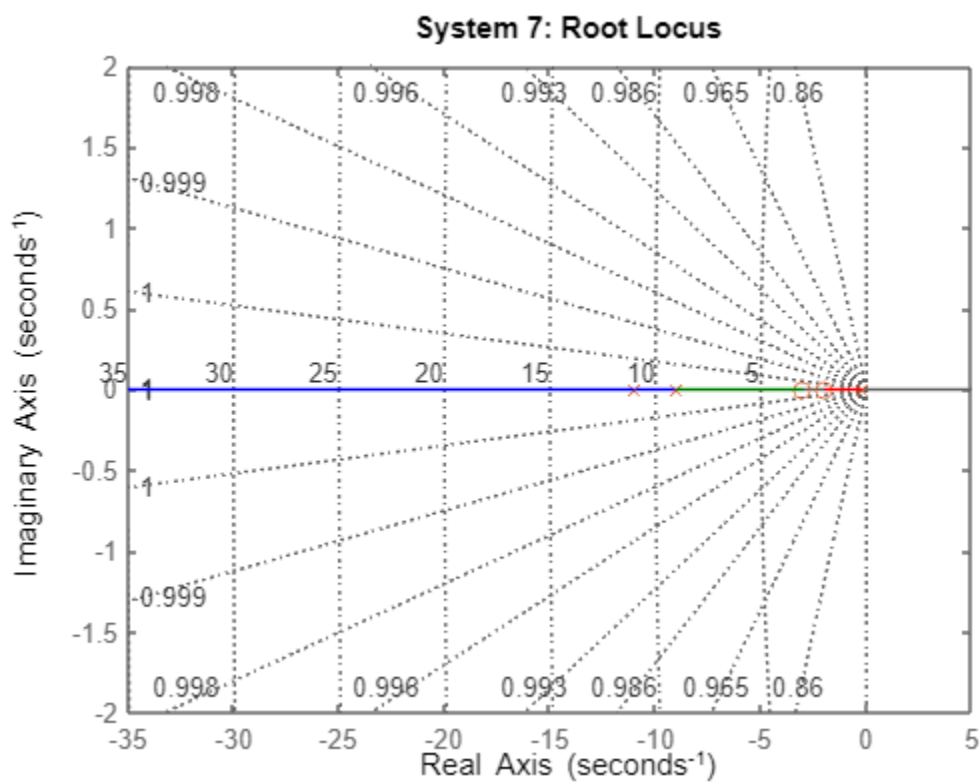
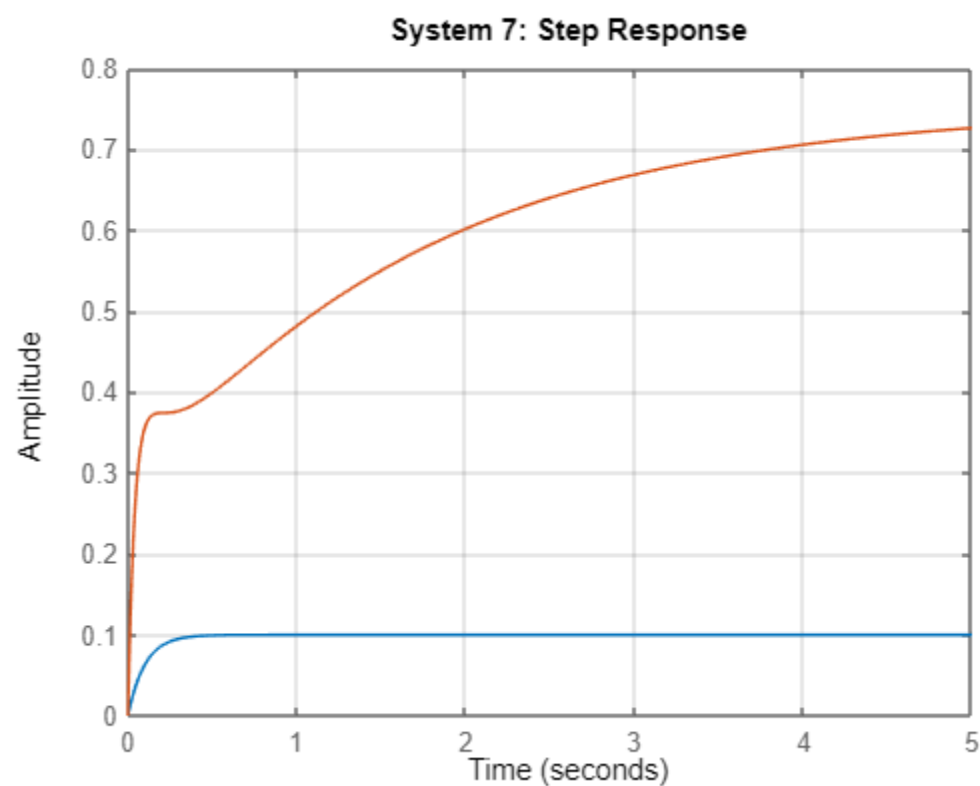


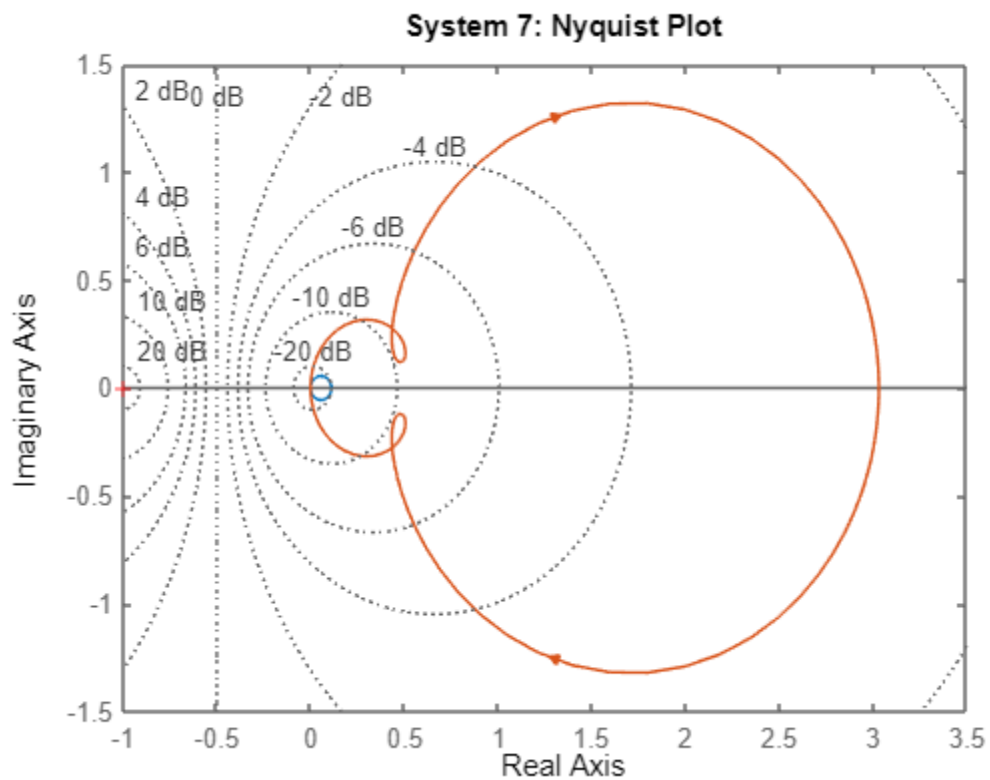


SYSTEM 6 PERFORMANCE

RiseTime: 0.2441
 TransientTime: 0.4347
 SettlingTime: 0.4347
 SettlingMin: 0.1005
 SettlingMax: 0.1111
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.1111
 PeakTime: 1.1718
 RiseTime: 2.9375
 TransientTime: 5.5159
 SettlingTime: 5.5159
 SettlingMin: 0.6960
 SettlingMax: 0.7730
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.7730
 PeakTime: 12.6369

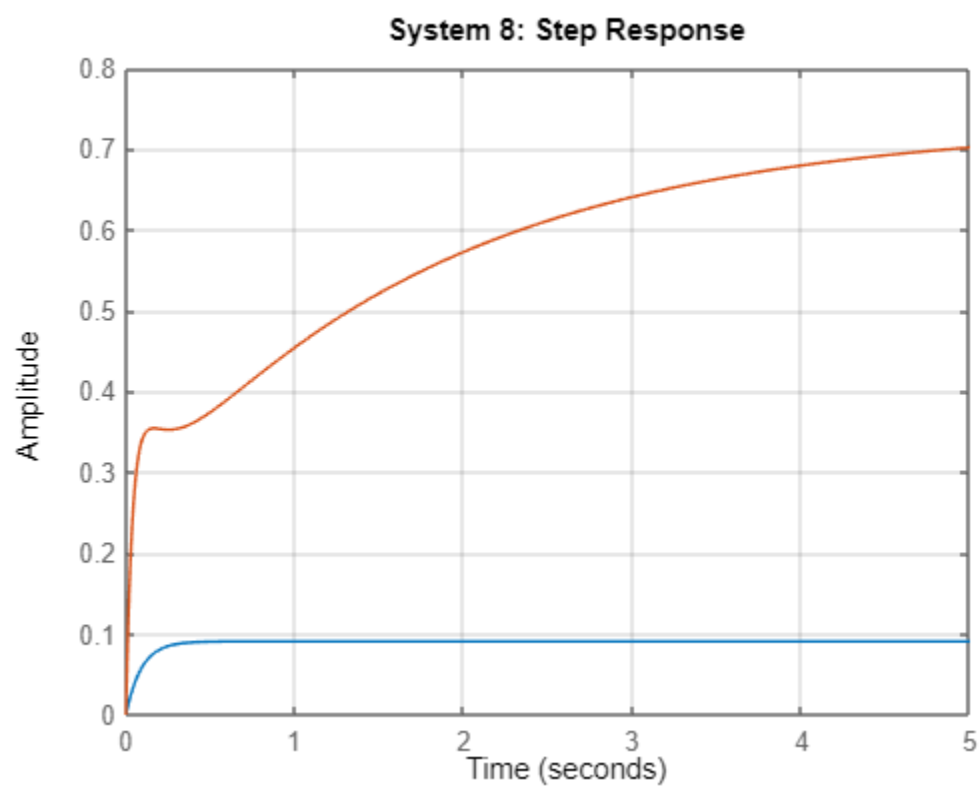
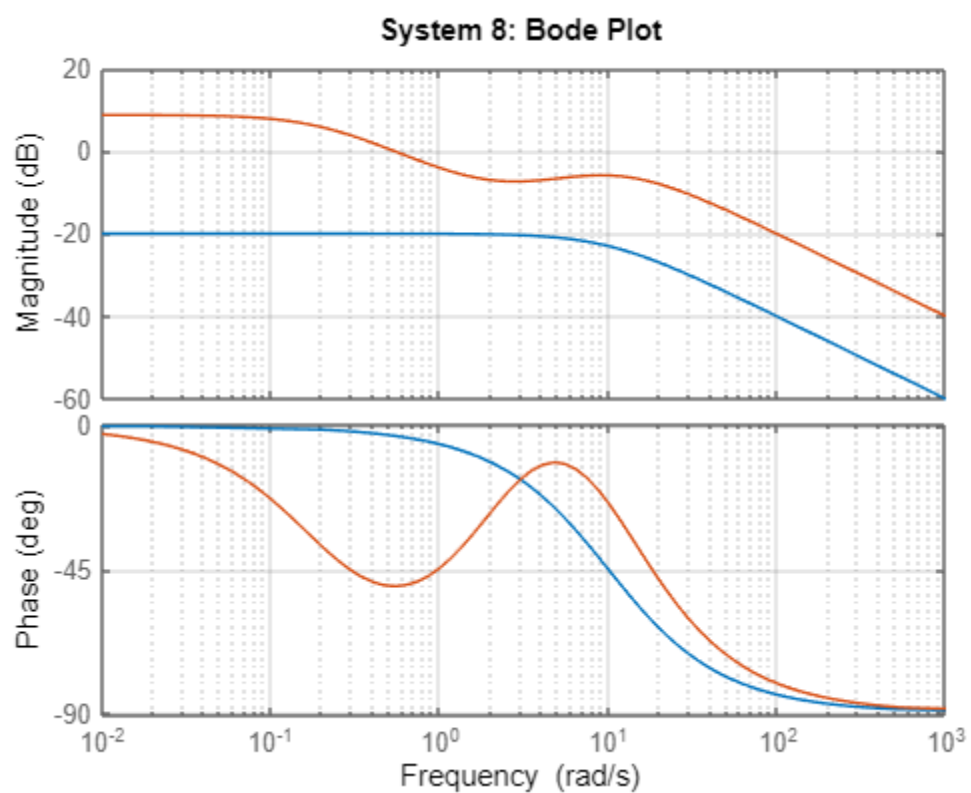


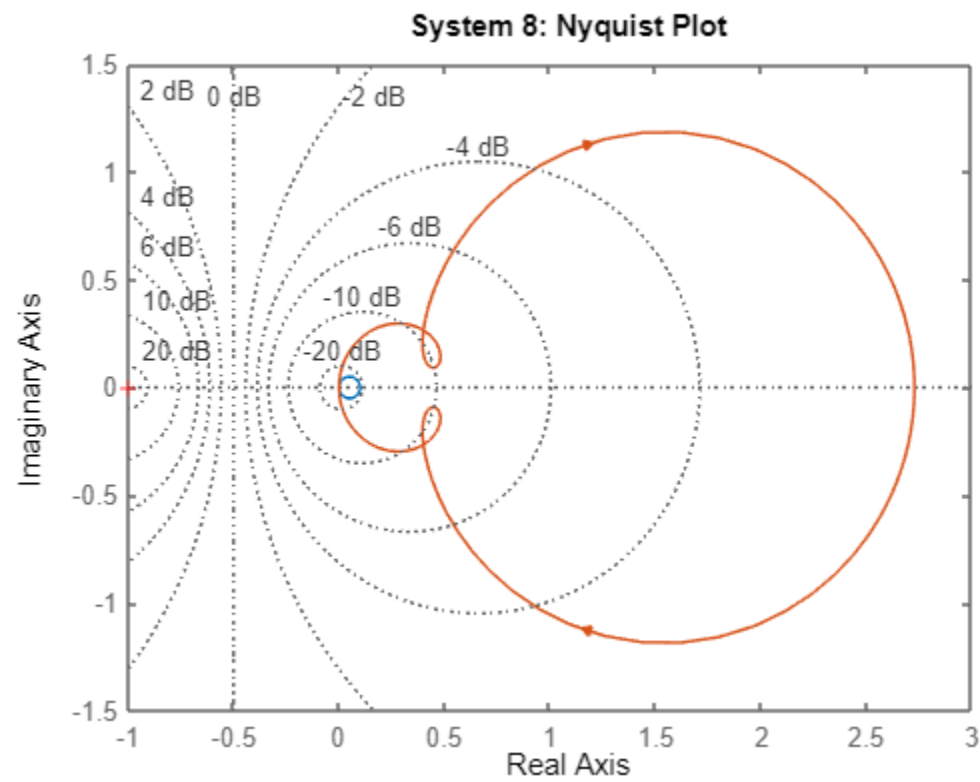
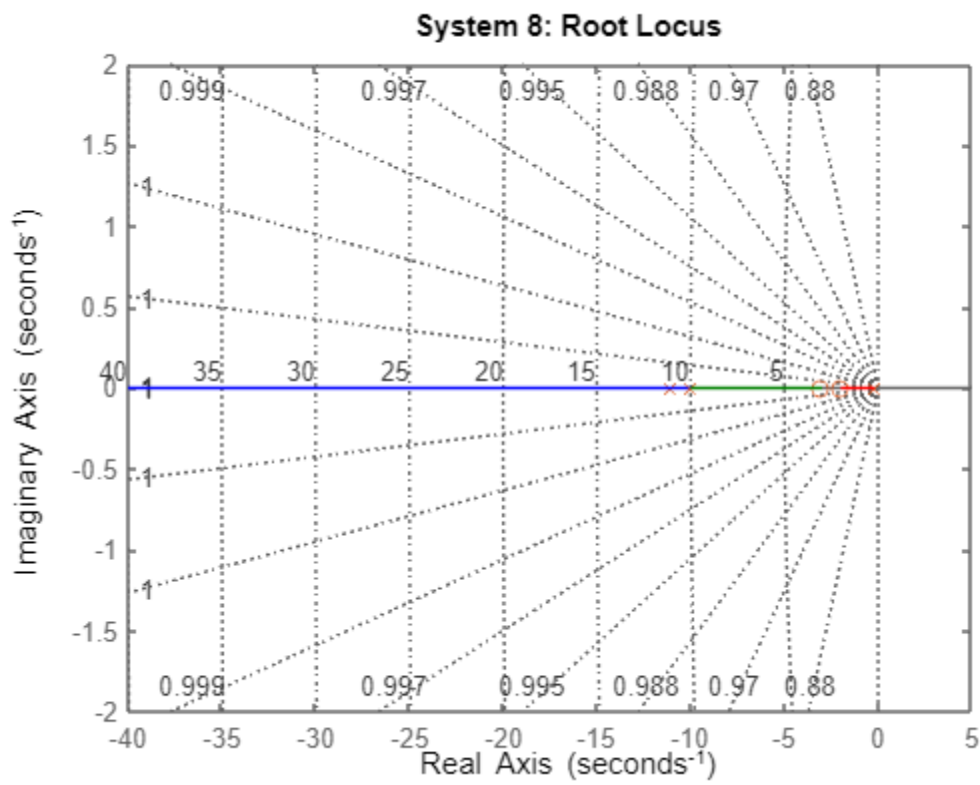




SYSTEM 7 PERFORMANCE

RiseTime: 0.2197
 TransientTime: 0.3912
 SettlingTime: 0.3912
 SettlingMin: 0.0905
 SettlingMax: 0.1000
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.1000
 PeakTime: 1.0546
 RiseTime: 3.1690
 TransientTime: 5.9116
 SettlingTime: 5.9116
 SettlingMin: 0.6768
 SettlingMax: 0.7504
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.7504
 PeakTime: 9.8021





SYSTEM 8 PERFORMANCE

RiseTime: 0.1997
 TransientTime: 0.3556
 SettlingTime: 0.3556
 SettlingMin: 0.0822
 SettlingMax: 0.0909
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.0909
 PeakTime: 0.9587
 RiseTime: 3.3853
 TransientTime: 6.2810
 SettlingTime: 6.2810
 SettlingMin: 0.6586
 SettlingMax: 0.7305
 Overshoot: 0
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.7305
 PeakTime: 10.7433

Design a lead and a lag compensator in a cascade compensation to improve the transient response of a second order system with the transfer function $G(s)$ Table 2.. Simulate the system using MATLAB and analyze the results Table 2

1	$G(s) = \frac{9}{s^2 + 4s + 9}$	5	$G(s) = \frac{16}{s^2 + 12s + 16}$
2	$G(s) = \frac{25}{s^2 + 6s + 25}$	6	$G(s) = \frac{8}{s^2 + 14s + 8}$
3	$G(s) = \frac{3}{s^2 + 10s + 3}$	7	$G(s) = \frac{9}{s^2 + 2s + 9}$
4	$G(s) = \frac{36}{s^2 + 6s + 36}$	8	$G(s) = \frac{8}{s^2 + 6s + 8}$

Table 2: Second Order system.

```

% NAME: Joshua Muthenya Wambua
% REG NO: EG209/109705/22
% DATE: 09-Nov-2025
% Objective:
%   To design and analyze a lead-lag compensated control system
%   for improved transient and steady-state performance.
clc; clear; close all;
% 1. Define system and compensators
s = tf('s'); % Laplace variable
% Uncompensated second-order plant
G1 = 9 / (s^2 + 4*s + 9);
% Lead compensator (improves transient response)
C_lead = 10 * (s + 3) / (s + 11);
% Lag compensator (improves steady-state error)
C_lag = (s + 2) / (s + 0.2);
% Combined lead-lag compensator
C_T = C_lead * C_lag;
% 2. Closed-loop transfer functions
T_uncomp = feedback(G1, 1); % Uncompensated closed-loop
T_comp = feedback(C_T * G1, 1); % Compensated closed-loop
% 3. Frequency Response Analysis
figure('Name','Bode Plot Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
bode(G1, C_T*G1);
grid on;
title('Bode Plot: Uncompensated vs Compensated');
legend('Uncompensated (Open-loop)', 'Compensated (Open-loop)', 'Location', 'best');
set(findall(gcf,'Type','line'),'LineWidth',1.5);
% 4. Step Response Analysis
figure('Name','Step Response Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
step(T_uncomp, T_comp, 4); % 4 seconds display window
grid on;
title('Step Response: Uncompensated vs Compensated');
legend('Uncompensated Closed-loop', 'Compensated Closed-loop', 'Location', 'best');
xlabel('Time (s)');
ylabel('Amplitude');
set(findall(gcf,'Type','line'),'LineWidth',1.5);
% 5. Root Locus & Nyquist Analysis
% Root Locus
figure('Name','Root Locus Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
rlocus(G1); hold on;
rlocus(C_T * G1);
grid on;
title('Root Locus: Uncompensated vs Compensated');
legend('Uncompensated', 'Compensated', 'Location', 'best');
% Nyquist Plot
figure('Name','Nyquist Plot Comparison','NumberTitle','off');
nyquist(G1, C_T*G1);
grid on;
title('Nyquist Plot: Uncompensated vs Compensated');
legend('Uncompensated', 'Compensated', 'Location', 'best');

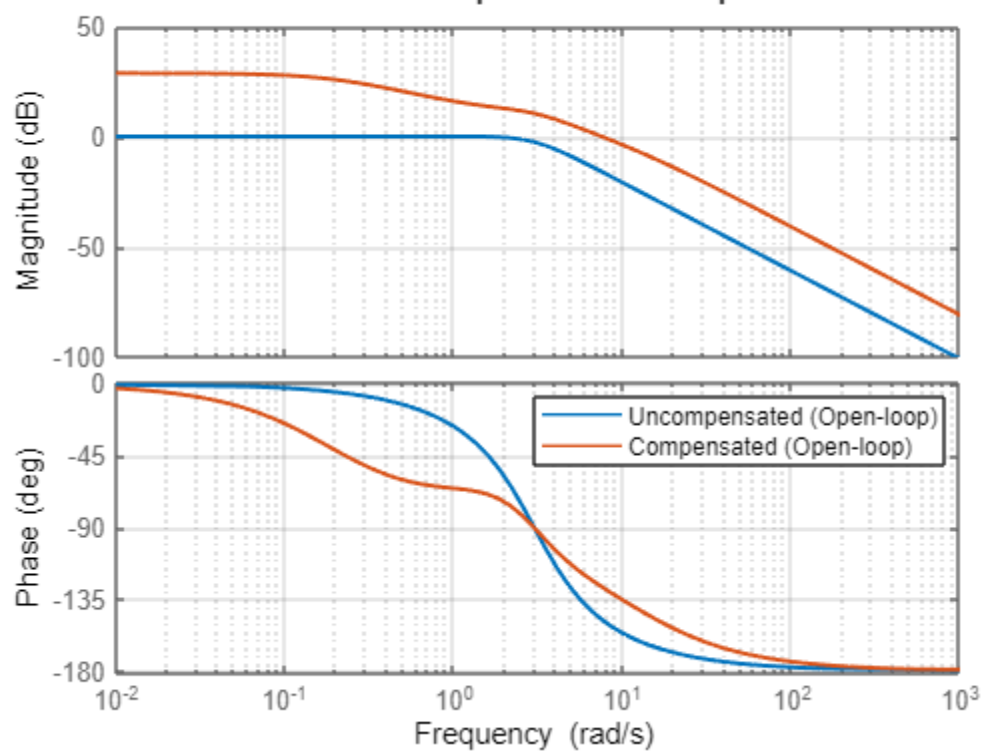
```

```

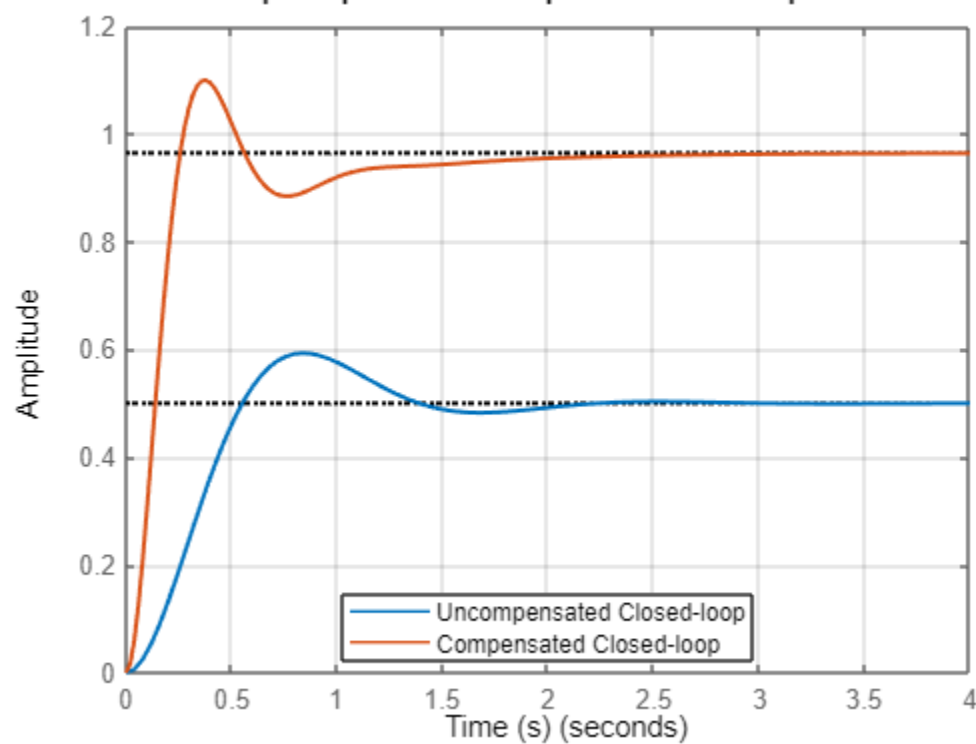
set(findall(gcf,'Type','line'),'LineWidth',1.2);
% 6. Performance Metrics
fprintf("\n=== PERFORMANCE COMPARISON ===\n");
info_uncomp = stepinfo(T_uncomp);
info_comp = stepinfo(T_comp);
disp('Uncompensated System:');
disp(info_uncomp);
disp('Compensated System:');
disp(info_comp);
% Compute steady-state error for a unit step
[~, ss_uncomp] = step(T_uncomp, 10);
[~, ss_comp] = step(T_comp, 10);
ess_uncomp = abs(1 - ss_uncomp(end));
ess_comp = abs(1 - ss_comp(end));
fprintf("\nSteady-State Error (Unit Step Input):\n");
fprintf('  Uncompensated: %.4f\n', ess_uncomp);
fprintf('  Compensated:   %.4f\n', ess_comp);
% 7. Summary Report (in Command Window)
fprintf("\n=== SYSTEM ANALYSIS SUMMARY ===\n");
fprintf('Lead compensator:   C_lead = 10*(s + 3)/(s + 11)\n');
fprintf('Lag compensator:    C_lag = (s + 2)/(s + 0.2)\n');
fprintf('Combined compensator: C_T = C_lead * C_lag\n');
fprintf("\nPerformance Insights:\n");
fprintf('  -> Lead compensation improves speed of response (reduces rise & settling time).\n');
fprintf('  -> Lag compensation improves steady-state accuracy (reduces steady-state error).\n');
fprintf('  -> Combined lead-lag provides both transient and steady-state improvements.\n');
fprintf('=====');

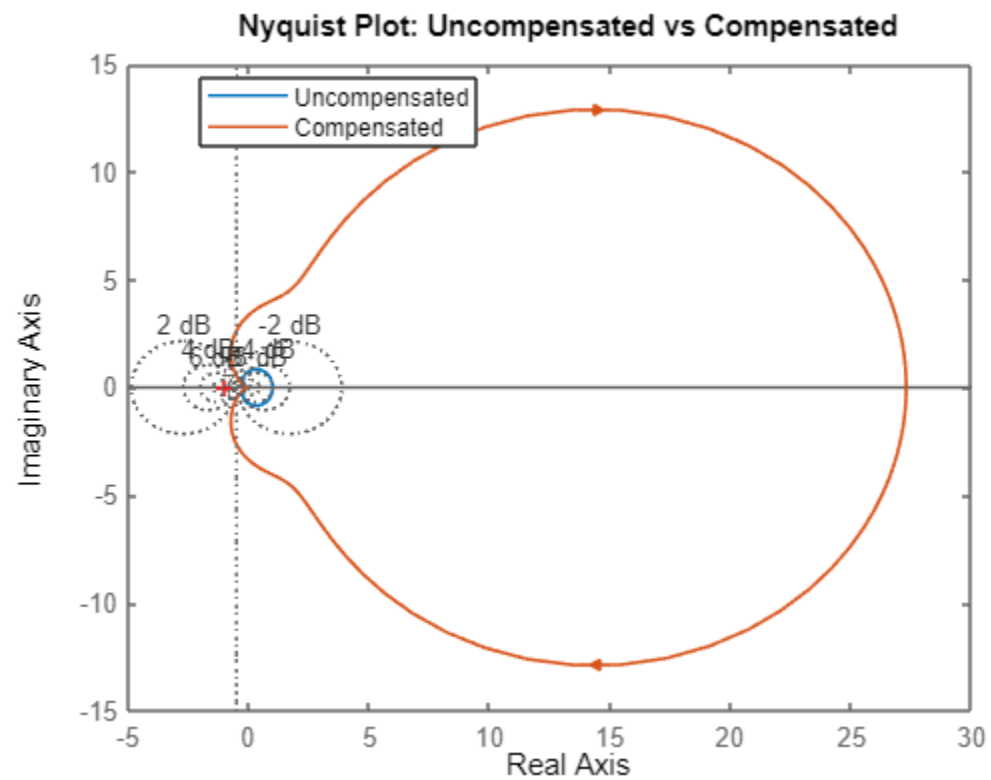
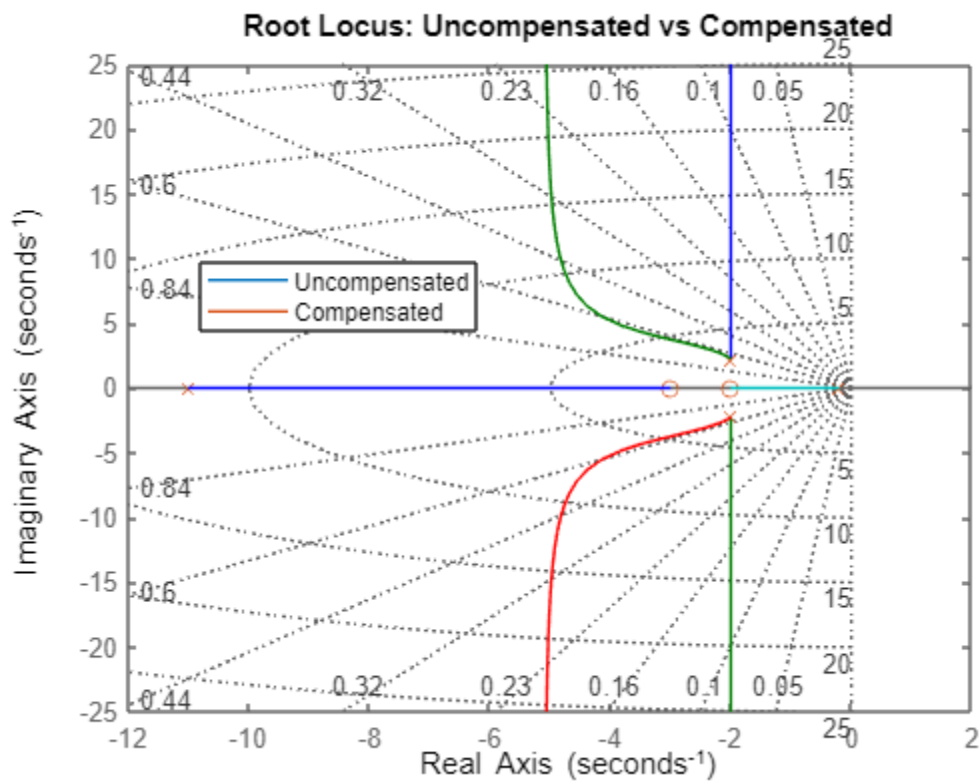
```

Bode Plot: Uncompensated vs Compensated



Step Response: Uncompensated vs Compensated





=== PERFORMANCE COMPARISON ===

Uncompensated System:
 RiseTime: 0.3735
 TransientTime: 1.9487
 SettlingTime: 1.9487
 SettlingMin: 0.4659
 SettlingMax: 0.5932
 Overshoot: 18.6319
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 0.5932
 PeakTime: 0.8289

Compensated System:
 RiseTime: 0.1746
 TransientTime: 1.5802
 SettlingTime: 1.5802
 SettlingMin: 0.8845
 SettlingMax: 1.0997
 Overshoot: 13.9976
 Undershoot: 0
 Peak: 1.0997
 PeakTime: 0.3759

Steady-State Error (Unit Step Input):
 Uncompensated: 9.0000
 Compensated: 9.0000

=== SYSTEM ANALYSIS SUMMARY ===

Lead compensator: $C_{lead} = 10 \cdot (s + 3) / (s + 11)$
 Lag compensator: $C_{lag} = (s + 2) / (s + 0.2)$
 Combined compensator: $C_T = C_{lead} \cdot C_{lag}$

Performance Insights:
 -> Lead compensation improves speed of response (reduces rise & settling time).
 -> Lag compensation improves steady-state accuracy (reduces steady-state error).
 -> Combined lead-lag provides both transient and steady-state improvements.

Chapter 5: Matlab Simulation and Results

5.1 Uncompensated System Response

The uncompensated system was simulated using MATLAB to obtain its step response and frequency response. The results showed moderate stability but limited transient performance.

5.2 Lead Compensated System

A lead compensator was designed and connected in cascade with the plant. MATLAB simulations showed that the lead compensator improved the transient response by reducing rise time and overshoot. The Bode plot indicated an increase in phase margin.

5.3 Lag Compensated System

A lag compensator was designed to improve steady-state accuracy. Simulation results demonstrated a reduction in steady-state error, although the transient response became slightly slower compared to the lead-compensated system.

5.4 Lead–Lag Compensated System

The lead and lag compensators were combined in cascade to form a lead–lag compensator. MATLAB results showed improved transient response and reduced steady-state error, achieving a balanced performance improvement. The Bode plot confirmed enhanced stability margins and desirable frequency characteristics.

6. Discussion

6.1 Difference Between Lead and Lag Compensators

Lead compensators primarily affect transient response by increasing phase margin and system speed, while lag compensators mainly improve steady-state accuracy by increasing low-frequency gain. Lead compensation reduces rise time and overshoot, whereas lag compensation reduces steady-state error.

6.2 Effect of Poles and Zeros on System Performance

The location of poles and zeros in the s-plane has a significant impact on system behavior. Poles closer to the imaginary axis result in slower response and higher overshoot, while poles further to the left improve stability and settling time. Zeros can be used to shape the transient response and influence overshoot and rise time.

6.3 Frequency-Domain Interpretation

Magnitude and phase plots are used to evaluate system stability margins and bandwidth. Lead compensators increase phase margin and bandwidth, improving stability and speed. Lag compensators increase low-frequency gain, enhancing steady-state accuracy without significantly affecting phase margin.

7. Applications

Dynamic compensation is widely used in practical engineering systems such as temperature control in HVAC systems, speed control of electric motors, and robotic arm positioning. Cascade compensation allows designers to fine-tune both transient and steady-state performance to meet application-specific requirements.

Conclusion

This laboratory experiment successfully demonstrated the application of lead, lag, and lead–lag compensators in improving control system performance. MATLAB simulations confirmed that lead compensation enhances transient response, lag compensation improves steady-state accuracy, and combined lead–lag compensation achieves balanced system performance. The results highlight the importance of pole-zero placement and frequency-domain analysis in compensator design.

References

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- ii. Dorf, R. C., & Bishop, R. H., *Modern Control Systems*, Pearson Education.
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